SLIDE 01 — ECOSYSTEM OVERVIEW

TrustMRR tracks the indie startup economy — and finds a two-tier market

TrustMRR is a verified revenue-tracking platform for the indie startup economy. The data shows a market split between a few big winners and many small earners.
many small earners.

1,000
Indie startups tracked
Dataset frozen Jul 30, 2026

$18M+
Aggregate 30-day revenue
Tracked across ecosystem

83.4%
Verified via Stripe
API integrations: Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, Whop

$278
Median monthly revenue
Per tracked company

BUSINESS MODEL & TRUST

- **Business model:** tracks real-time financial data for 1,000 indie startups (dataset frozen July 30, frozen July 30, 2026).
- **How we verify:** data comes from direct API links to payment gateways. 83.4% of the ecosystem uses Stripe; others include RevenueCat, Paddle, and Whop.
- **Scale:** tracks $18M+ in total 30-day revenue, MRR, active subscriptions, and for-sale multiples.

TWO-TIER REALITY

TOP OF MARKET — STAN
$2.8M/mo revenue
$3.5M MRR

≈10,000× GAP

MEDIAN COMPANY
$278/mo revenue

A few top earners take most of the revenue, while the median company makes just $278/month.

SOURCE: TRUSTMRR DATASET (FROZEN JUL 30, 2026)

SLIDE 02 — GROWTH & DURABILITY

Median growth is flat at 0%, and reported revenue hides hidden churn

The indie market has stalled at 0% median growth. Reported revenue often hides customer churn and data quality risks.

0%

Median 30-day revenue & MRR growth

The mode of the ecosystem

$187

Median MRR

Micro-business baseline

~15%

Companies with revenue but 0 subscriptions

The zero-subscription paradox

WHAT THE NUMBERS SIGNAL

- **Zero is the mode:** median 30-day revenue and MRR growth are both exactly 0%. The 42% mean growth is mean growth is pulled up by a few extreme outliers (e.g., Stealth Company-17: 71,890% revenue growth). growth).
- **Low MRR baseline:** median MRR is only $187. Most tracked companies are tiny businesses fighting to survive, not to scale.
- **Zero-subscription paradox:** about 15% of companies report 30-day revenue but show 0 active subscriptions.
- **Risk:** this points to one-time sales, fully lost customers, or broken data feeds — making revenue durability hard to trust.

OUTLIER INFLATION

MEDIAN GROWTH

0% in 30 days

Half the market is shrinking or flat

STEALTH COMPANY-17

OUTLIER

+71,890% revenue growth

Single outlier inflates the 42% mean

The 42% mean growth is a distorted number, not a real market signal.

SOURCE: TRUSTMRR DATASET (N=1,000, FROZEN JUL 30, 2026)

SLIDE 03 — MONETIZATION PREMIUM

Hidden B2B companies clearly beat branded consumer startups on revenue

Unnamed B2B companies earn far more than branded, consumer-facing ones. Stealth and B2B are the two biggest revenue drivers.

STEALTH VS NAMED STARTUPS

Stealth Outperforms Brand

REVENUE

Stealth median rev	$1,395
Named median rev	$278

5× HIGHER REVENUE

MRR

Stealth median MRR	$1,262
Named median MRR	$187

6.7× HIGHER MRR

B2B VS B2C MONETIZATION

B2B Dividend

REVENUE

B2B median rev	$1,068
B2C median rev	$445

2.4× BETTER MONETIZATION

Audience type is the strongest predictor of revenue.

CATEGORY GLUT VS GOLD

Category Median Revenue (by company count)

AI 197 companies	$503	CROWDED
Marketing	$2,370	UNDERSERVED
Education	$2,436	UNDERSERVED

AI is the most crowded category but pays the least. Less crowded ones earn 4–5× more.

TOP EARNERS PER VISITOR

$1,515

Laper: revenue per visitor

Median ecosystem: $0.40 per visitor

3,787× GAP VS MEDIAN

SOURCE: TRUSTMRR DATASET (N=1,000, FROZEN JUL 30, 2026)

SLIDE 04 — FOR-SALE DISCONNECT

26% of the market is for sale at high multiples despite flat growth

26% of tracked companies are listed for sale. Most ask for high multiples even though their growth is flat.

262
Companies listed for sale
26% of the 1,000-company dataset

2.3×
Median asking multiple
On revenue

0% DISCONNECT
Median seller growth rate
Flat at the time of listing

ABUN.COM
OUTLIER

REVENUE	ASKING PRICE	MULTIPLE
$24/mo	$50K	172× MULTIPLE

Seller is pricing 172× current revenue.

BASED LABS AI
OUTLIER

REVENUE	ASKING PRICE	STATUS
$0/mo	$2.18M	NO REVENUE

Speculative listing — zero revenue, multi-million dollar ask.

MARKET IMPLICATION

Sellers are pricing in future hope, not current growth. This creates a clear buying chance for acquirers who focus on real growth, not growth, not asking multiples.

SOURCE: TRUSTMRR DATASET (N=1,000, FROZEN JUL 30, 2026)

SLIDE 05 — STRATEGIC IMPERATIVES

Winners will buy stealth B2B assets and enforce stricter subscription checks

The market needs consolidation. Winners will acquire stealth B2B assets and require stricter subscription verification.

PLATFORM

Restore trust, unlock hidden value

- Add a "Verified MRR" badge that requires active active subscription checks. This solves the zero-subscription paradox.
- Launch a "Stealth Index" to surface unnamed top performers and unlock hidden market value.

✓ FOR TRUSTMRR (PLATFORM)

ACQUIRERS

Buy growth, not multiples

- Target stealth B2B assets in Marketing, Education, and Analytics. Look for positive growth and asking multiples below 3×.
- Avoid the crowded AI category — too many players, low median revenue, speculative asks.

↗ FOR ACQUIRERS / INVESTORS

FOUNDERS

Focus on durable revenue

- Pivot to B2B audiences to capture the 2.4× revenue revenue boost.
- Delay branding spend to stay stealth longer and protect pricing power.
- Optimize for revenue per visitor, not raw traffic.

➤ FOR FOUNDERS / OPERATORS

OVERALL CONCLUSION

The easy wins are gone. The market is splitting into two groups: lifestyle businesses (0% growth) and high-growth breakout breakout companies. Position accordingly.

SOURCE: TRUSTMRR DATASET (N=1,000, FROZEN JUL 30, 2026)